

## **Inclusive Diversity** – How Leaders can play their Role?



Do you have a diverse & inclusive workplace? **Diversity** at the workplace involves having a range of different people with various characteristics, while **inclusion** ensures that these individuals are all actively engaged, respected, & able to thrive within the workplace.

If you work at a company where you are not valued because of your ethnicity or culture & are not given opportunities for growth, will you do your job wholeheartedly? **Research by McKinsey states that companies promoting diversity & inclusion are 35% more likely to outperform their competitors.**

This means that a diverse workforce that feels a sense of belonging to the company they work for are sure to work harder for the betterment of the company. Altogether this highlights the importance for you, as a Leader, to work towards inclusive diversity. Grab a cup of coffee & let's jump into the details.

### **What is Inclusive Diversity?**

Inclusive Diversity is a concept that combines the ideas of diversity & inclusion into a cohesive approach that not only focuses on bringing diverse individuals into an organization but also ensures that they are fully integrated, valued, & supported once they are there.

It is not enough to simply have a diverse group of people; inclusive diversity ensures that these individuals are actively involved in all aspects of the organization. This means they are not just present but are integral to decision-making, project leadership, & other key functions.

**Teams that are diverse are naturally 87% better at making decisions that enhance the company's objectives.** This is because Inclusive Diversity focuses on creating systems, policies,

& practices that support & uplift diverse individuals. It involves identifying & dismantling systemic barriers that might hinder the participation or advancement of diverse individuals.

It also aims to build a culture where everyone feels they belong. This includes fostering an environment where employees feel they can be their authentic selves without fear of discrimination or exclusion. This approach leads to a more engaged & innovative workforce & creates a more [equitable & supportive workplace](#).

## **Strategies that Leaders can Inculcate**

### **1. Develop a Clear Vision & Action Plan**

As a Leader, you need to articulate a clear vision for inclusive diversity that aligns with the organization's mission & values. Set specific, measurable goals & create a strategic plan that outlines how to achieve them. One goal that you can set is increasing the number of women & minorities in leadership roles by a certain percentage within a set timeframe. This will work towards making your organization an inclusive one.

### **2. [Model Inclusive Behavior](#)**

Demonstrate inclusive behavior through your actions & interactions. Show respect for diverse perspectives, listen actively, & engage in open, empathetic communication. Participate in & support diversity & inclusion initiatives that are taken in your organization. Offer [constructive](#) feedback & encouragement to team members from all backgrounds.

### **3. Promote Accountability**

Develop clear metrics to measure progress toward diversity & inclusion goals. Use these metrics to track & report on achievements & areas for improvement. Designate individuals or teams responsible for overseeing & implementing D&I initiatives. Include diversity & inclusion goals in performance evaluations for [Leaders & Managers](#).

### **4. Foster an Inclusive Culture**

Develop policies that support an inclusive work environment, such as flexible work arrangements & anti-discrimination policies. Encourage collaboration & interaction among employees from diverse backgrounds. Actively address any issues or conflicts related to inclusion as they arise.

### **5. Train Others**

Offer regular training sessions on unconscious bias, cultural competence, & inclusive leadership. Encourage employees to pursue ongoing education on diversity & inclusion topics. If possible, bring in external consultants or trainers to provide specialized knowledge & perspectives.

### **6. Address Possible Barriers**

Regularly review organizational policies, practices, & structures to identify & address systemic barriers to inclusion. Adjust hiring, promotion, & compensation practices to ensure they are equitable & inclusive. Continuously seek feedback & make improvements based on employee experiences & changing needs.

#### **7. Recognize & Celebrate Achievements**

Publicly recognize & celebrate the achievements of individuals & teams that contribute to diversity & inclusion. Share success stories & [best practices](#) related to diversity & inclusion within the organization. Implement awards or recognition programs for employees who make significant contributions to promoting an inclusive culture. This will encourage others to contribute to this too.

#### **8. Commit to Continuous Inclusive Diversity**

Keep up to date with best practices, emerging trends, & new research related to diversity & inclusion. Engage with industry experts, attend conferences, & participate in professional networks focused on diversity & inclusion. Regularly review & refine your D&I strategies based on new information & feedback.

### **Benefits of Inclusive Diversity**

Inclusive diversity offers many benefits that significantly enhance organizational success & employee well-being. This diversity improves decision-making processes by broadening the range of considerations & reducing biases, resulting in more balanced & effective strategies.

Furthermore, an inclusive environment boosts employee satisfaction & retention, as individuals who feel valued & supported are more engaged & committed to their roles. It also broadens market reach, as diverse teams are better equipped to understand & cater to a wide array of customer needs, thus enhancing brand loyalty & competitive advantage.

Additionally, inclusive practices help mitigate legal risks & enhance compliance with anti-discrimination laws, while fostering a collaborative & respectful workplace culture. Ultimately, inclusive diversity strengthens an organization's global competency, enabling it to navigate & thrive in diverse markets & cultural contexts.

To learn how you can work towards inclusive diversity at your workplace, connect with our experts who provide executive coaching for Leaders to enable them to build a sustainable & cultural mindset. [Visit the website & avail yourself of our services.](#)

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**Focus:** Inclusive Diversity

**Meta Description:** Inclusive Diversity at the workplace helps foster a collaborative & respectful workplace culture. Learn how.